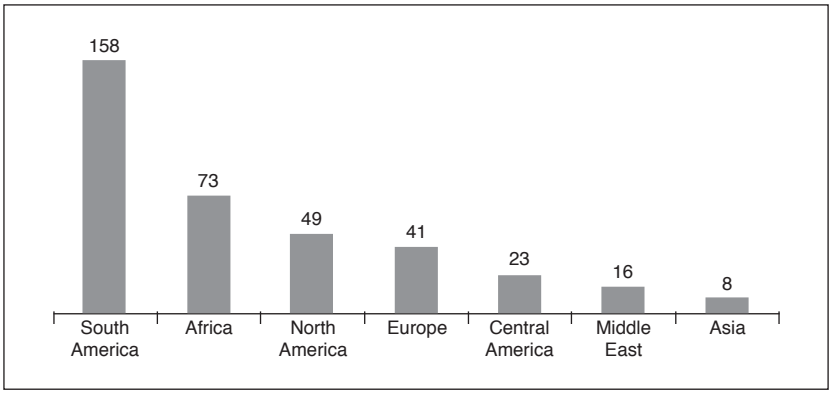
**Figure 2. Distribution of contracts per continent/region**




*Source: prepared by the author.*

Constructions (BPC) and Andrade Gutierrez acquired the Zagope construction company, both having a reasonable portfolio of ongoing works in the country. In this way the presence of Brazilian contractors in the Portuguese market was focused on the activities of their subsidiary companies, which are responsible for 33 of the 35 Brazilian construction contracts in the country. Furthermore, the fact that Portugal is a Lusophone country facilitated the Brazilian companies' entrance; it also accounts for their intense activity in other Portuguese-speaking nations, above all in Africa.

A significant aspect of the geographical distribution of Brazilian contracts is their limited activity, even recently, in the 'emerging' markets of the other BRICS members. Even though, in recent years, China, India, Russia and South Africa have implemented diverse infrastructure projects, Brazilian civil engineering firms have participated little in this process. Thus, up until 2010, there were only two contracts signed in South Africa, four in China, one in India and one in Russia, but none of them were long-term or of great monetary value. The explanation seems to lie in the fact that these markets are relatively restricted to local heavy construction firms or to firms of countries that have traditionally dominated them.

In addition, it is possible to observe that, of the 12 countries with more than ten Brazilian construction company contracts, nine are in South America. Only three countries are outside this region: North America, Europe and one African country. In this sample of 255 contracts (out of the total of 368) in countries with more than 10 contracts with Brazilian firms, 157 or 61.5% are in South American countries. Of these, Chile had the largest number, with 29 projects up until